



(From left) Iris Cordoba Mondejar, Alan Davis, Chintan Shah and Mahesh V. Panchagnula share a light moment with a group selfie during the Playcom 2025: Business of Sports Summit. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

CricViz's Alan Davis: Balance needed for AI usage in sports

There exists a need for balance while harnessing Artificial Intelligence in sports, said Alan Davis, Marketing Head, CricViz, during a panel at the PlayCom 2025: Business of Sports Summit.

"With anything to do with AI and technology, it's about accuracy, depth of data. For example, we've got records of 75,000 cricketers. Ultimately, yes, we can run that through systems and programs and models, but you still need an element of human intelligence to match that," said Davis. The session, titled 'Wired for Winning: Tech, AI & the Science of Sport,' also featured Iris Cordoba

Mondejar, Managing Director, GSIC Powered by Microsoft, and Chintan Shah, SVP – Teams, Leagues & Federations, Sportz Interactive and was moderated by Mahesh V. Panchagnula, Head, IIT Madras Centre of Excellence on Sports Science and Analytics.

Chintan spoke about the seasonal nature of Indian sports. "During the off-season, what we try to do is to build digital stadiums where you can give those experiences to the fans. And that's where technology can play a big role. The only challenge is that most of the teams are trying to do this on social media, which is again one too many. It's important to shift the focus to doing this on your own

platforms, where you can track the user behaviour and drive meaningful conversation," he said.

Meanwhile, Mondejar underlined that technology in sports is not restricted to corporate entities.

"It's not only an opportunity for entrepreneurs, it's a need for the government. In a country in Europe where health care is public, you need to prevent obesity in kids. And fitness, wellness, practice, sport, is something that we need to promote in our country and in our family, because it's the way to reduce the cost of expenses in the future for the hospital, but also for your insurance or for your family or to extend your life," said Mondejar.